

Contact

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Top Skills

Financial Modeling
SaaS Metrics
Leadership

Languages

English
Hindi
Tamil
Malayalam

Certifications

New Manager Foundations

Chithra Rajagopalan

Finance Leader | Philanthropist
San Francisco, California, United States

Summary

Finance leader with experience in high-growth SaaS companies. Formerly led accounting and finance functions for many fast paced start-ups, internally and as a consultant. Successfully led companies through fundraises, acquisitions, international expansions and IPO readiness. Strong business partner and an effective advisor to executive management team. Implemented and streamlined financial/operational policies and procedures.

Serves as a board member of a non-profit that supports nurse retention during these challenging times, and is also on the board for a non-profit that helps underprivileged kids, by breaking the caste system ceiling.

Specialities: Go-To-Market Finance & Strategy, Financial Modeling, Fundraising, Investor Reporting, Due Diligence, SaaS Metrics and KPI Analysis, GAAP Accounting, IPO Readiness, Annual Planning, Audit, PLG and B2B Enterprise FP&A.

Experience

Obsidian Security
Head of Finance
October 2023 - Present (2 years 10 months)
Palo Alto, California, United States

Campfire (YC S23)
Investor | Advisory Board
May 2023 - Present (3 years 3 months)
San Francisco Bay Area

Blossom Projects
President and Treasurer
March 2019 - Present (7 years 5 months)
Menlo Park, California, United States

Glue

Head of Finance (Acquired)

December 2022 - October 2023 (11 months)

San Francisco, California, United States

Glue is an AI-powered connection platform that uses machine learning and network analysis to find the connection opportunities among employees and teams. The platform automatically examines workplace tools where employees digitally interact, such as Slack and calendars, and generates data to help People leaders take action.

Glue recently went through a PE acquisition, where I led the pre & post M&A work. I led the Strategic Finance, Accounting, Tax, and Sales Ops team at Glue.

- Revamping the operational financial model connecting KPIs, pipeline funnel model and sales capacity model, which enabled to set and measure company targets.
- Building the Balance sheet, Cash Flow and working capital forecast in the operating model
- Building bottoms up revenue recognition model for PLG and B2B revenue streams
- Partnered deeply with Sales leadership on pipeline strategy, building SQL and Opps qualification process
- Working on CS strategy build out and customer journey map
- Leading the venture debt round (SVB), along with pre and post due diligence
- Leading the 409A valuations
- Owning the board meeting prep and financial overview presentations at quarterly board meetings

ClickUp

Director of Corporate FP&A

August 2021 - September 2022 (1 year 2 months)

San Diego, California, United States

ClickUp is a Series C SaaS company valued at \$4 billion. ClickUp is a productivity app which provides a set of tools for its users to tackle project management, document collaboration, spreadsheets, chat and goals from a single platform.

I am leading the Corporate FP&A department at ClickUp.

- Built and led the annual planning cycle for the company
- Leading investor relations/reporting and board reporting

- Revamped financial model and reporting to include more robust cash and burn forecast
- Leading the GTM FP&A function as a business partner to the sales and marketing team
- Strategy support and SaaS reporting to executive teams

People.ai

1 year 5 months

Director Of Finance And Accounting

April 2021 - August 2021 (5 months)

San Francisco Bay Area

Functioned as the lead for all the accounting and finance operations for the company

- Leading the first external audit for the company
- Finance liaison for the latest acquisitions and M&A operations.
- Finance lead for the \$1M fund raise for company's Series D round and post close due diligence
- GTM Finance support for company's PLG operations and strategy

Assistant Controller

April 2020 - April 2021 (1 year 1 month)

San Francisco Bay Area

Leading Accounting and Finance function at People.ai. Responsible for month close work for parent and subsidiaries, customer invoicing, accounts payable, intercompany transactions, and other high priority areas such as:

- Leading M&A operations
- ASC606 study and implementation
- NetSuite implementation for parent and subsidiaries (One World and Planning & Budgeting module)
- Prepare and maintain SaaS Revenue Forecast. Work with Sales Operations and Sales leadership on SaaS revenue and bookings forecasts and targets.
- Leading annual 409A valuation
- Responsible for leading company's annual planning, budgeting and continued operational forecasting.
- Review of customer contracts and order forms
- Work with Sales Ops on Sales Compensation process, including setting quotas, compensation plan design and sales incentives.
- Responsible for headcount planning and forecasting for parent and subsidiaries.

- Responsible for maintaining financial models to track and analyze key metrics to ensure strategic, ROI based decision making.
- Responsible for maintaining and reporting key metrics including, NRR, GRR, Gross Margin, Bookings, Cash Burn, Cash out date, LTV, LTV to CAC, ASP, AE productivity/capacity assumptions etc.
- Lead various operational efficiency projects and other benchmark analysis to help leadership attain better visibility around the path to strategic growth.

Kranz & Associates

Accounting Manager

February 2019 - March 2020 (1 year 2 months)

San Francisco Bay Area

Worked closely with the CEO's, CFO's in providing superior accounting and financial

consulting advisory services. Handling the AR, AP, SaaS revenue recognition, board prep, payroll,

State/Fed tax compliances, financial reporting, audit, annual budget, sales commission, variable

comp policies, ASC606 implementation, ERP system implementations, Sales tax set up, and

advising/strategizing/implementing policies, process improvements etc. for the clients.

Other Executive & Leadership Roles:

- Leading the new client proposal & lead qualification process for Kranz and Associates.
- Working with the CFOs and executive team to put together the Kranz 2020 Budget and new business plan for Emerging Growth sector.
- Leading the new hire onboarding and employee training department for Kranz & Associates.

Kruze Consulting - Startup Accounting, Tax, Finance & HR

2 years 7 months

Director of Technical Accounting

January 2019 - February 2019 (2 months)

San Francisco Bay Area

Controller

September 2017 - February 2019 (1 year 6 months)

San Francisco Bay Area

- Provided effective leadership through the oversight of month, quarter and year end close operations for over 170+ startup ventures.
- Involved in 5+ financial models that raised \$70+ million; efficient in SaaS metric models and budgets vs actuals reporting.

Head of San Jose Executive Operations

May 2018 - January 2019 (9 months)

San Jose, California

- Instrumental in the establishment and continued management over the firm's first regional office and operations in San Jose.
- Responsible for leading, overseeing and developing an overseas team of accounting and finance professionals based in Asia.
- Core member of the firms' Recruiting Committee, and was instrumental in the hiring of the executive members of the management, and other critical staff in both the San Francisco and San Jose offices.

Senior Accountant

February 2017 - August 2017 (7 months)

San Francisco

- Severed as the Finance and Accounting Consultant for \$40 million client by closely working with the executive members and also helping out with the Series C round.
- Provided multitude of core accounting, finance and operations support to various startups which in total raised over \$80 million in funds.

Staff Accountant

August 2016 - February 2017 (7 months)

San Francisco

- Prepare financial reports by collecting, analyzing, and summarizing account information and trends.
- Perform monthly bank reconciliations, and manage accounts receivable and payable for each client.

Ernst & Young

Associate Analyst

February 2014 - August 2014 (7 months)

India

- Member of the Quality & Risk Management division of EY India. Engaged in in-depth governance, independence and independence analysis, to determine risk factors that may affect quality standards of a public company.

- Involved with frequent communication of global counterparts in the ongoing execution of responsibilities.
- Applied own judgment in proposing solutions to address critical conflict issues and develop reports.

Deloitte

Tax Consultant

August 2013 - January 2014 (6 months)

Hyderabad Area, India

- Development of web-based technology designed to perform partnership tax compliance processes and workflow improvements.
- Technology development support through rigorous testing of internal applications to enhance performance.
- Preparation of templates used for the generation of federal and state forms K-1.

Reliance

Intern

June 2012 - September 2012 (4 months)

- Research conducted to measure the change in value of the firm due to changes in the financing mixes.
- Performed in depth financial analysis to draw conclusions for the research.

Education

SCMS GROUP OF INSTITUTIONS

Master of Business Administration - MBA, Finance and Marketing · (2011 - 2013)

Mahatma Gandhi University

Bachelor's Degree, Bachelor of Commerce (B.Com) in Taxation · (2008 - 2011)